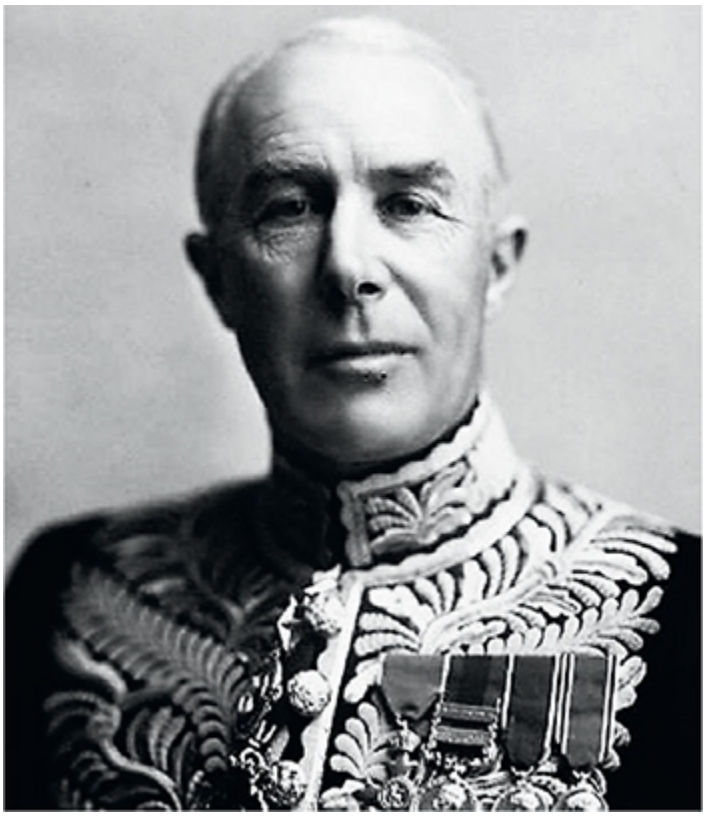


Image 3.2: Sir George Cunningham, Governor of NWFP
Source: Flickr Account of Dr Ghulam Nabi Qazi

In 1946, Sir George Cunningham ICS was the Governor of the NWFP,[8] and was perhaps the most well-informed British civil servant to have served in NWFP. He was fluent in Pushto and Hindko and was a proponent of the Forward School that advocated an aggressive stance by the Government of India at its frontiers. He strongly believed in Pax Britannica and presumed that despite Indian independence, the Gilgit Agency would continue to be a British administered leasehold property, somewhat like Hong Kong. It provided the British with a vital listening post in Central Asia. Before he resigned as the Governor of NWFP, Cunningham recommended one of his most trusted officers from the NWFP, Lt. Col. Roger Bacon, to take over as the Political Agent in the Gilgit Agency. This was ostensibly to the prepare the vassal rulers of the Gilgit Agency for the changes that were likely to